

ChatGPT Clone

User Manual

Overview

A full-stack ChatGPT-style application that allows users to: - Create and manage chat sessions\

- Send messages and receive AI responses\
- Upload files for AI processing\
- View persistent chat history

Before Opening the App (Localhost Setup)

Make sure the following are ready:

- Node.js and npm installed\
- Docker installed and running (if using Docker)\
- Internet connection (for AI responses)

Run the application:

Option 1: Without Docker

```
npm install  
npm start
```

Option 2: With Docker

```
docker compose up --build
```

Access the App

Open your browser and go to:

<http://localhost:3000>

Features

- Real-time messaging (Socket.IO)\
- User authentication (signup/login/logout)\
- Persistent chat sessions (MongoDB)\
- File upload with AI processing\
- Search, filter, and sort conversations\
- Docker-based deployment

Getting Started

1. Open the application\
2. Sign up or log in\
3. Access the dashboard

Authentication

- **Sign Up:** Create a new account\
- **Login:** Enter username and password\
- **Logout:** Profile icon → Logout

Chat Sessions

- Click **New Chat** to start\
- Select chats from sidebar\
- Sessions are saved automatically

Managing Chats

Users can: - Rename chats\

- Delete chats\
- Pin/unpin chats\
- Search conversations\
- Filter (All / Pinned / Unpinned)\
- Sort (Newest / Oldest / A--Z)

Sending Messages

- Type in input box\
- Press **Enter** or click send\
- AI responds in real time\
- Thinking indicator shows while waiting

File Upload

- Click  icon\
- Upload file (PDF, TXT, DOCX, XLSX, image)\
- File shows as preview in chat\
- AI processes file internally

Chat History

- Conversations are saved automatically\
- Reloading keeps chat history\
- Each user sees only their chats

Sidebar Features

- Collapse/expand sidebar\
- Resize sidebar width\
- Search chats\
- Filter and sort conversations

System Behavior

- Real-time updates using WebSockets\
- Handles disconnect/reconnect automatically\
- Fast and responsive UI

Requirements (Sprint-Based)

- Backend persistence for conversations\
- Search, filter, and sort chats\
- Real-time AI messaging with thinking indicator\
- User authentication\
- File attachment with preview\
- Testing and Docker deployment

Testing

- Unit Tests\
- Integration Tests\
- Regression Tests\
- Acceptance Tests

Troubleshooting

- Ensure Docker is running\
- Check internet connection\
- Restart backend if needed\
- Refresh page if connection issues occur

Conclusion

This app provides: - Real-time AI chat\

- Persistent conversations\
- File upload support\
- User-specific sessions\
- Docker-based deployment